

Rajendra Rawat

Agentic AI · Digital Transformation · Strategic Engineering Leader · Australia

[GitHub](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [Kaggle](#) | [Website](#)

About

Strategic technology leader with nearly two decades of global experience across 20+ verticals including Education and Retail. Operated across North America, EMEA, and APAC, currently based in Australia. I bridge hands-on AI engineering and executive strategy - having advised CIOs, led enterprise-scale digital transformation, and independently built production-grade agentic AI systems.

I have been building AI systems since 2015 (7 years before the ChatGPT wave) from enterprise conversational AI at scale to training language models from scratch and deploying hardened autonomous agents on sovereign local infrastructure.

Independent Research & Projects

✓ COGNI-BRAIN

Hardened agentic deployment on DGX Spark

Nemotron-3-Super-120B running at 23.2 TPS with NemoHermes inside an OpenShell kernel-level sandbox. No cloud, no data leaving the building.

- [View Repository](#)

Demonstrates sovereign AI deployment pattern applicable to regulated industries where data cannot leave organisational boundaries.

✓ SAGE-GPT

Sanskrit SLM trained entirely from scratch on DGX Spark

7.5M parameter decoder-only Transformer trained on ~140M Sanskrit tokens. Grokking strategy induced for genuine generalisation.

- [View Repository](#)

✓ **COGNI.CHAT**

Local-first multimodal AI agent platform

Orchestrating Cogni intelligence designed to support the human mind, body, and spirit.

- [Visit cogni.chat](#)

✓ **FIDUCIARY-OPS-AGENT**

Autonomous enterprise governance agent

Check-then-Act protocol via Gemini 2.5 Flash Lite. Enforces real-time fiduciary risk-alignment.

- [View Repository](#)
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Work Experience

2021 - PRESENT

✓ **Tribe Lead · Digital Strategy & R&D**

ASX-listed retail group · Australia

Led end-to-end re-platform of legacy on-prem e-commerce to cloud-native MACH architecture across 8 microservices teams (~25 engineers) in a broader program of 40+ including QA, support, and external partners. Delivered the foundational infrastructure layer required for AI readiness at scale.

Driving SaaS rationalisation and open-source migration strategy to reduce platform costs. Evaluating and proposing AI-assisted SDLC tooling (GitHub Copilot, Codex) to automate engineering workflows across the organisation.

2018 - 2020

✓ **Technical Program Lead · Advisor to CIO**

Australian Catholic University (via Espire) · Australia

Advisor to CIO across 8 global campuses. Deployed AVA conversational AI agent serving students university-wide. Delivered AI-driven campus transformation featured in 2 Microsoft Global Case Studies. Recipient of the Outstanding Contribution to Digital Transformation award.

2013 - 2021

✓ **Director of Technology · Microsoft & Emerging Tech**

Espire Infolabs · Gurugram, India

Reporting to CEO. Grew global Microsoft practice to multi-million dollar accounts while

incubating AI/IoT Centres of Excellence. Architected the company's first enterprise AI chatbot in 2015 - predating the LLM wave by 7 years capability which evolved into commercial deployments at ACU and Victoria University bots.

2006 - 2013

Consultant

Microsoft · Hyderabad, India

Architected mission-critical systems for Fortune Global 500: Chevron, Merck, Franklin Templeton, Aviva...

Credentials

Year	Milestone	Issuer	Link
2025	✅ AI Agents Intensive Course	Google · Kaggle	Verify
2021	✅ Azure Data Scientist Associate	Microsoft	Verify
2021	✅ Azure AI Engineer Associate	Microsoft	Verify
2021	Azure Developer Associate	Microsoft	Verify
2020	✅ Managing ML Projects	Google Cloud	Verify
2019	✅ Deep Learning Specialisation	DeepLearning.AI	Verify
2019	✅ Machine Learning Certificate	Stanford University	Verify
2017	✅ Data Science Orientation	Microsoft · edX	Verify

Awards

- ✅ Outstanding Contribution to Digital Transformation (2020) · Australian Catholic University | [View](#)
- Gem of the Year (2019 · 2018) · Espire Infolabs
- Automation Champion (2017) · Espire Infolabs